

The Great Commission

Go and Tell Everyone!

A Sunday School Lesson Plan
Matthew 28:16-20

Ages 4 - 10 | Approx. 45-60 minutes

Lesson at a Glance

Theme	Jesus sends US to share His love with everyone!
Passage	Matthew 28:16-20 (The Great Commission)
Ages	4 - 10 (with split-age discussion tips)
Time	Approx. 45 - 60 minutes
Big Idea	Jesus has ALL authority - and He is ALWAYS with us.
Take-Home	This week I will tell one person about Jesus.

1. Welcome & Opening Prayer

5 minutes

Greet each child by name as they arrive. Make every child feel seen and special.

Opening Prayer (say together):

"Dear Jesus, thank You for loving us. Help us learn how to share Your love with others today. Amen."

2. Icebreaker: Pass the Message

5 - 7 minutes

How to Play:

- Have all the kids sit in a circle.
- Whisper a short phrase to the first child (e.g., "Jesus loves you!").
- They whisper it down the line, one child at a time.
- The last child stands up and says it out loud.

Tie-In:

"Today we will learn that Jesus gave His friends a very important message to pass on - and it is our job to pass it on too!"

3. Bible Story: The Great Commission

10 minutes | Read Matthew 28:16-20 (NirV or ICB works well for kids)

Tell it in your own words:

- After Jesus rose from the dead, He met His 11 disciples on a mountain in Galilee.
- They worshiped Him - some still doubted, but Jesus loved them anyway.
- Jesus said something HUGE: *"All authority in heaven and earth is mine!"*
- Then He gave them a MISSION - called the Great Commission.
- Best promise: *"I am with you always, to the very end of the age."*

The 4 Big Action Words

What Jesus told His disciples (and us!) to do:

GO

Go to ALL people, everywhere in the world.

MAKE DISCIPLES

Help others become friends and followers of Jesus.

BAPTIZE

In the name of the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit.

TEACH

Teach them everything Jesus taught us.

4. Memory Verse

5 minutes

*"And surely I am with you always,
to the very end of the age."*

- Matthew 28:20

Hand Motions (great for younger kids!):

- "Surely I am with you" - point up, then to self, then to others
- "Always" - draw a big circle with arms
- "To the very end of the age" - stretch arms wide
- Repeat together 3 times!

5. Discussion Questions

5 - 7 minutes | Split into age groups if possible

Ages 4 - 6	Ages 7 - 10
• Who told the disciples to go tell others about Him? • Does Jesus stay with us? (Yes - always!) • Who can YOU tell about Jesus this week?	• Why did Jesus say "ALL authority" BEFORE giving the mission? • What does "make disciples" actually mean? (Not just tell - help them follow Jesus.) • The disciples doubted, but Jesus still used them. What does that tell us?

6. Craft Activity

10 - 15 minutes | Pick ONE option (or let kids choose)

Option A: Paper Plate Globe	Option B: Footprint Path
<i>Best for ages 4 - 6</i>	<i>Best for ages 7 - 10</i>
Color a paper plate blue and green to look like Earth. Add stickers or drawings of people from different places. Write "GO!" across the top in big letters. Supplies: paper plates, blue and green markers/paint, stickers.	Trace each child's foot on colored paper and cut it out. On each footprint, write ONE way they can share Jesus this week. (Examples: be kind, invite a friend, pray, share, forgive.) Tape all the footprints as a path on the classroom wall. Supplies: colored paper, scissors, markers, tape.

7. Game: "Go Tag"

5 - 10 minutes | Play in a safe open space

How to Play:

- One child starts as "It."
- When they tag someone, that person is NOT out - instead, they BOTH become "It."
- The pair holds hands and tags more kids together.
- Each new tag joins the chain. Soon EVERYONE is part of the team!

The Lesson:

"That is how the church grows - one person tells another, who tells another, who tells another. Jesus message spreads everywhere!"

8. Closing & Sending Prayer

3 minutes

Have the kids stand up. Say together:

*"Jesus, thank You for being with us ALWAYS.
This week, help us GO and share Your love with one person. Amen!"*

Send each child out with a high-five and the words: **"Go and tell!"**

Take-Home Challenge

Send each child home with a small card:

MY MISSION THIS WEEK

This week I will tell _____ about Jesus.

"And surely I am with you always." - Matthew 28:20

Ask kids to bring the card back next week to share what happened. Celebrate every story!

Teacher Tips & Supply List

Teacher Tips	Supplies Checklist
• Use a kid-friendly Bible (NirV or ICB). • If your group is wide-aged, pair an older kid with a younger one. • Repetition helps - say the memory verse often. • Affirm every answer, even if it is wrong. • If time runs short, skip the game - protect the Bible story and prayer.	• Kid-friendly Bible • Paper plates, markers, paint, stickers • Colored paper, scissors, tape • Memory verse take-home cards • Open space for the tag game • Optional: small reward stickers

Go and Tell!

"Therefore go and make disciples of all nations..."

Matthew 28:19
